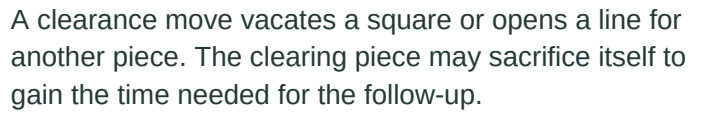


Clearance tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c4. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 23...Qf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

24. Qxf5 gxf5 25. Nd2 f4 26. Rf3

24.Qxf5 The queen captures the queen on f5. Recorded reply: **24...gxf5**.

25.Nd2 The knight moves from f3 to d2. From d2 it attacks rook on b3 and bishop on c4. Recorded reply: **25...f4**.

26.Rf3 The rook moves from e3 to f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.